

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in case file management, deadline tracking, procedural document preparation and client communication gained at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in maintaining organised matter records, coordinating documents across complex proceedings, drafting correspondence and explaining procedural requirements to clients. Seeking to build a specialism in intellectual property, bringing strong legal research skills, close attention to detail and a background in process-driven legal work.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: development of GDPR across jurisdictions — examined how a single regulatory framework applies differently in different legal systems

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial client instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets procedural deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance for individuals unfamiliar with the relevant processes
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the only junior supporting the team ahead of a significant submission deadline, helping ensure on-time filing
- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Conducted legal research; liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials, and supported hearing preparation across several matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, deadline tracking and matter opening and closure
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Deadline and portfolio monitoring, evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation across multiple concurrent matters